cilities at that institution. Howev- with poorer credentials will take

FIRING LINE

Board defaults on duties

Last Friday the Texas Union Board of Directors made a decision which will undoubtedly affect the finances of UT students. In a motion to table a vote on contracting the Union Dining Services, UDS, the board acted fiscally irresponsible. Why?

■ The UDS is incapable of self-operating without subsidies from student fees.

■ At its current rate, the UDS will fail to contribute $212,892 to its overhead expenses next year alone and over a two-year period more than $425,000. This money must be recovered somehow and there appear to be only two solutions. First, Union programming money will be slashed even though it is already grossly underfunded. Second, the student union fee will have to be increased.

As the Texas Union operations council coordinator and future board member, I am angered by the decision of the board to default on its responsibility. Yes, student input should be given regarding contracting of the Texas Union dining facilities. However, students, as well as Union employees need to have all the information.

First, the board's decision doesn't guarantee the future employment of UDS workers. Second, it could result in elimination of Union programming.

Finally, if the board fails to address the real issue of financial responsibility, the result could be another fee increase.

Michael Tooker
Texas Union operations council coordinator

Editor's Note: This letter was signed by 55 others.

Horn blasting misses key

Okay, Bryan Solie, take crayon in hand (for the purpose of taking notes), and I will explain to you why your analysis of Joseph Horn's statements in Tuesday's Viewpoint ("Professor's froth doesn't ring true," *The Daily Texan*) is as ill-conceived as that bastard child of the BSA, the Project PRIDE initiative.



■ The PRIDE proposal is "exclusionary" because it fails to include such cultures as those of Asia and Latin America, both of which have contributed more tangibly to the amalgam of cultures the people of Texas (as in "The University of") now enjoy than have those of Africa.

■ Horn implicitly endorses a mandatory cultural studies course, and accurately portrays the BSA's resistance to making such a course inclusionary.

■ Finally, Bryan, your statement characterizing Horn's desire that students who are not willing to work in class not be allowed to continue to waste valuable University resources as amounting "to no more than flunking (excluding) more students" springs from a logic so twisted that it is truly comical.

At first I was puzzled as to why Karen Adams would attach her name to such a large serving of editorial tripe as Solie's.

Then I realized it was due to the same dynamic that produced that vessel of legalized discrimination known as affirmative action: it is amazing what a guilt-ridden white liberal apologist will do in the face of radically bent minority to avoid being stuck with the racist badge.

Ray Suhler
UT Alumnus

GLSA supports BSA plan

Representing the members of the Gay and Lesbian Students' Association, we, the board members of the GLSA, endorse and give our full support to the Black Students' Alliance and PRIDE.

As advocates of human rights, the GLSA recognizes the importance and saliency of the movement for equality and just recognition brought to light by Marcus Brown and his constituents in the BSA and elsewhere on campus. The board-members of GLSA feel it is imperative for us to support these ideals of equality and liberty that we hold dear and fight for on a daily basis.

We applaud the efforts of the BSA and the proposals outlined in PRIDE and also ask that those individuals and organizations who recognize this as not only a move for improved education about people of color and their culture, but also as a general movement toward basic human rights for all of us, to voice their support publically.

David Miller
Computer science

Flim-flam tuition scams

It's amazing the number of contexts in which various forms of perpetual motion machines have been conceived. Historically, such contraptions have generally been associated with the loathsome profession of the flim-flam artist.

The recent proposal by Dean Robert Boyer and company for tuition doubling of graduate students as a means of generating revenue for graduate students is no exception. We recently attended a meeting addressing the tuition doubling issue in which Boyer spent the first 30 minutes lamenting the financial woes of graduate students, emphasizing the poor competitiveness of the University with other schools for graduate funding.

His solution — perpetual motion — raise funds from the graduate students so that funds can be allocated to graduate students. Sound familiar? In short, it doesn't take much to deduce that a only a redistribution of the "wealth" is possible, if indeed it is solely earmarked for graduate students.

If graduate students are already in dire straits, who goes under and who stays afloat with the slight-of-hand take and give, especially those not fortunate enough to be supported by a TA/RA?

Boyer claims that there's actually an open loop in this scheme, namely that there's money to be gleaned from the supporting governments of foreign students and the grant coffers of benevolent professors in order for both to keep their students buoyant.

Attention foreign students? Does this mean that you're not paying enough? We know plenty of foreign students who pay their way. Attention professors, does this make sense — to divert research funds to tuition in order to enhance research capacity?

Finally, the amount of funds "freed up" is given in the range of $340,000 — not very much to spread around the individual colleges, especially in the light of the University's operating budget to the tune of $325 million. Anyone ever consider generating revenue by eliminating waste or streamlining the administration?

Unless Boyer really believes in perpetual motion, the only reasonable explanation for the tuition doubling is that it is a preliminary step to double undergraduate tuition. Have you been to the colleges of Architecture and Engineering lately? The theme is divide and raise tuition. Call it what it is and spare us the snake oil.

Andrew Maynard
Edward Yonemoto
Chemistry graduate students

Don't compromise rights

I just wanted to thank Jonathan Nash ("Compromise on class issue", *Firing Line*, Tuesday) for speaking for us white, male, middle-class "moderates." Now maybe we should make a distinction between informed moderates and uninformed moderates.

The University "does not seem to have" funds for multicultural classes? Under what bush hast thou been hiding thine head, Jonathan?

This is *our* university. Our rights should be asserted, not compromised. I am sick and tired of an administration that systematically ignores undergraduates of every persuasion. We should all rage like London anarchists until things are right.

Sidney Childress
Finance